

AccuKnox vs Prisma Cloud Compute

Workloads On-Prem With Prisma. Everything On-Prem With AccuKnox.

Prisma Cloud Compute Edition is the self-hosted edition of Prisma Cloud. It includes the Cloud Workload Protection Platform (CWPP) module only. Cloud posture sits in Prisma Cloud Enterprise Edition, which Palo Alto Networks runs as SaaS. AccuKnox installs its control plane on your servers or in an air-gapped network. It runs every feature there except AI CoPilot (AskADA).^{1,34,35}

Compared with Prisma Cloud Compute Edition (self-hosted), per its administrator guide read on 2026-10-06.³⁶

✓ Supported — Limited, partial or coming soon ✗ Not supported Superscripts link to the numbered sources.

Parameters



Prisma Cloud Compute Edition

DEPLOYMENT AND DATA RESIDENCY

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Modules Available On-Prem	✓ All features run on-prem except AI CoPilot (AskADA) ¹	— CWPP module only. CSPM is in Enterprise Edition (SaaS) ³⁴
On-Prem Control Plane	✓ Native install on your servers, VMs or bare metal ¹	✓ Self-hosted Console on any container host, Kubernetes or OpenShift ³⁴
Air-Gapped Operation	✓ Isolated network with no call-home, images staged in own registry ¹	✓ Listed for air-gapped sites, with manual threat feed loading ³⁵
Data Residency and Telemetry	✓ No data egress on-prem. Control plane pulls image and chart updates ¹	✓ Data stays on your Console. Anonymous telemetry on by default, can be off ³⁷
Multi-Tenancy	✓ Each tenant runs in its own K8s namespace ²	✓ Projects: one Console per tenant behind a central Console ³⁸

APPLICATION SECURITY

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Secrets (Repo / IaC)	✓ Repos, pipelines, IaC, correlated in ASPM ³	— Secrets in images, containers, hosts. Not in repos or IaC files ³⁹
Code Quality (Best Practices)	✓ 2-engine SAST, 14 languages, SonarQube gates ⁴	✗ Repo scans check package dependencies only. No source code analysis ⁴⁰
SAST	✓ Pipeline and IDE SAST ⁵	✗ No SAST scanner. CWPP module only ³⁴
DAST	✓ 4 scan types, incl. authenticated behind MFA ⁶	✗ No DAST scanner. WAAS protects running web apps and APIs ³⁴
SARIF Ingestion	✓ Any tool: Checkmarx, JFrog, Gitleaks, Sonatype ⁷	✗ No SARIF import. CWPP module only ³⁴
Repo / CI/CD Integration	✓ GitHub, GitLab, Bitbucket + 9 CI/CD platforms ⁸	— Jenkins plugin plus twistcli for other CI. No repo-host apps ⁴¹
Container Scanning	✓ CI/CD, registry, in-cluster, deploy blocking ⁹	✓ Image CVE scans in CI, 13 registry types, deployed images ⁴²
Generate & Ingest SBOMs	✓ CycloneDX out, CycloneDX or SPDX in ¹⁰	— Exports CycloneDX 1.4. No SBOM import ⁴³

CLOUD SECURITY POSTURE

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CSPM (AWS, Azure, GCP)	✓ CSPM on all 3 clouds with CDR auto-remediation ^{11,12,13}	— No CSPM. CWPP module only ⁴⁴
Multi-Cloud Asset Inventory	✓ One inventory of accounts, assets, workloads ¹⁴	— Discovers VMs, K8s, registries, serverless on 3 clouds ⁴⁵
Private Cloud (OpenShift / Nutanix)	✓ OpenShift, Nutanix, VMware Tanzu enforcement ¹⁵	— OpenShift 4.12 to 4.22 and Tanzu. Nutanix not listed ⁴⁶
Real-Time Cloud Event Automation	✓ CDR alerts on CloudTrail events, triggers remediation ¹⁶	✗ No cloud audit-event alerting. CWPP module only ³⁴
Compliance Frameworks	✓ 42 benchmarks incl. ISO 27001, NIST, CIS, PCI, SOC 2, HIPAA ¹⁷	— 8 CIS benchmarks plus PCI DSS, HIPAA, NIST 800-190, GDPR, DISA STIG ⁴⁷

WORKLOAD AND KUBERNETES RUNTIME

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Container & K8s Runtime	✓ Process, file, network enforcement + microsegmentation ¹⁸	✓ Learned models and rules with Alert, Prevent, Block ⁴⁸
Preemptive / Inline Blocking	✓ Kernel LSM stops a process before it runs ¹⁹	✓ Prevent stops the violating process. Block stops the container ⁴⁸
eBPF / Kernel Enforcement	✓ eBPF plus AppArmor, SELinux, BPF-LSM ¹⁹	✗ Linux Defender runs in user space, not as a kernel module. eBPF not named ⁴⁹
Process Allow / Deny	✓ Per-pod or per-host process policies ¹⁸	✓ Allowed and denied process lists per rule ⁴⁸
File Integrity Monitoring	✓ Monitors and blocks critical path changes ²⁰	✓ Host FIM. Container writes block by directory ⁵⁰
Workload Anomaly Detection	✓ Learns baseline, blocks deviations ²¹	✓ Learned models, 1h learning, 24h dry run ⁴⁸
K8s Misconfiguration	✓ Findings with fix steps and Jira tickets ²²	✓ CIS node checks plus OPA admission rules ⁵¹
Trusted Registry Enforcement	✓ KnoxGuard admission per cluster or namespace ²³	✓ Trusted Images rules. Alert or block ⁵²

KUBERNETES IDENTITY (KIEM)

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KIEM (K8s Entitlements)	✓ RBAC search, graph, 15 risk queries ²⁴	— Alerts on K8s audit events only. No RBAC entitlement analysis ⁵³
Service Account Inventory	✓ Service accounts, roles, bindings per cluster ²⁴	✗ No K8s RBAC or service account inventory. CWPP only ³⁴
Over-Permission Detection	✓ Flags principals with excess privileges ²⁴	✗ No RBAC privilege analysis. CWPP only ³⁴
Risky Bindings & Cluster-Admin	✓ Flags roles that modify workloads or read secrets ²⁴	— Custom audit rules alert on events. No binding risk analysis ⁵³
Stale K8s Entitlements	✓ Unused roles and orphan service accounts ²⁴	✗ No stale entitlement analysis. CWPP only ³⁴

API SECURITY

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North-South (NGINX Ingress)	✓ NGINX Ingress connector feeds API inventory ²⁵	— WAAS inspects at the app container. No ingress connector documented ⁵⁴
TLS Classification at Ingress	✓ Inspects TLS, flags misconfigurations ²⁶	— Per-endpoint TLS with a supplied certificate. No TLS report ⁵⁵
Shadow API Detection	✓ Traffic vs OpenAPI spec ²⁷	✓ WAAS alerts or blocks paths missing from the imported spec ⁵⁶
Zombie API Detection	✓ Zombie and orphan APIs vs spec ²⁷	— Last-seen date per endpoint. No zombie API flag ⁵⁷

DATA SECURITY (DSPM)

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Data Discovery	✓ S3, Blob, cloud and self-hosted DBs, Drive, Salesforce ²⁸	✗ No DSPM. CWPP module only ³⁴
Data Classification	✓ 283 classes, PII, PHI, PCI, secrets, 62 country packs ²⁸	✗ No data classification. CWPP module only ³⁴

AI SECURITY

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LLM Red Teaming	✓ Bedrock, Vertex AI, AI Foundry, Triton, vLLM ²⁹	✗ No AI security module. CWPP module only ³⁴
Prompt Firewall	✓ Inline: blocks, masks or logs prompts and responses ³⁰	✗ No prompt firewall. CWPP module only ³⁴
OWASP LLM Top 10	✓ v2025 mapped in AI-SPM and red teaming ¹⁷	✗ No OWASP LLM Top 10 mapping. CWPP module only ³⁴
AI/ML Runtime Sandboxing	✓ ModelArmor sandboxes models and agents ³¹	— Generic runtime defense. No AI-specific sandbox ⁴⁸

INTEGRATIONS

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Bi-Directional Ticketing	✓ Ticket closes finding, recurrence reopens it ³²	— Alerts create Jira issues and ServiceNow incidents. Push only ⁵⁸
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Why Customers Choose AccuKnox Over Prisma Cloud Compute Edition



Better

AccuKnox covers code, cloud, Kubernetes, data and AI from one on-prem control plane. Compute Edition covers workloads, and its docs list no SAST, DAST, DSPM or AI security module.^{1,34}



Faster

KubeArmor enforces policy inline at the kernel, so a disallowed process stops before it runs. The Compute Edition Linux Defender runs in user space. At one of India's top 3 public sector banks, AccuKnox cut remediation time by 91% and false positives by 89%.^{19,33,49}



Affordable

One AccuKnox platform includes SAST, DAST, DSPM and AI security on-prem. Compute Edition licenses each protected host, container host and function with credits, and covers workload protection only.^{1,59}

Sources

Prisma Cloud facts come from the Prisma Cloud Compute Edition administrator guide at docs.prismacloud.io, read on 2026-10-06. AccuKnox facts come from help.accuknox.com and one published AccuKnox case study. Palo Alto Networks also sells Prisma Cloud Enterprise Edition (SaaS) and Cortex Cloud, and their capabilities differ from this table.

1. [ACCUKNOX Deployment](#)
2. [ACCUKNOX Multitenancy](#)
3. [ACCUKNOX ASPM FAQs](#)
4. [ACCUKNOX SAST support matrix](#)
5. [ACCUKNOX 3.4 release](#)
6. [ACCUKNOX DAST scan types](#)
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